

Show, Don't Tell - Emotions and Setting

English - Year 5 | Descriptive Writing | ACARA v9.0: AC9E5LY06

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0: AC9E5LY06 - plan, create and edit written texts for imaginative, informative and persuasive purposes.

Learning Intention

I can show emotions and mood through actions, dialogue, body language and setting details.

Writing Strategy

Avoid simply naming the emotion. Show what the character does, says, notices and feels in their body.

Writing Topic: Improve a scene by showing emotions through actions, body language, dialogue and setting details instead of simply naming the feeling.

Vocabulary Helper

body language	movements or posture that show feelings
mood	the feeling created in a scene
precise verb	a strong action word that gives a clear picture

A. Plan Your Writing

Emotion What feeling will you show?	
Actions What does the character do?	
Setting How can the place match the mood?	
Dialogue What could the character say?	

Show, Don't Tell Emotions Toolkit

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Sentence Starters

- Instead of saying nervous, I could show...
- The character looked at...
- Their hands...
- The room seemed...

Mini Model / Success Guide

Zara held the certificate with both hands. A smile spread across her face, and she looked back at her teacher before standing a little taller. Likely feeling: proud or happy.

A. Warm Up

Choose one emotion and list three actions that could show it.

B. Build Your Skills

Rewrite this sentence by showing the feeling: Liam was worried.

C. Strong Challenge

Write a short scene where the setting helps show the character's mood.

Draft Your Show, Don't Tell Emotions

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Write a complete draft. Use your plan, clear paragraphs, precise vocabulary and correct punctuation. Leave time to reread and improve one sentence.

Title: _____

Edit, Check and Reflect

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Student Checklist - Tick What You Included

☐ I showed emotion through actions.	☐ I used body language.
☐ I added setting details.	☐ I used precise verbs.
☐ I included dialogue or thoughts.	☐ I avoided simply naming every feeling.
☐ I checked sentence variety.	☐ I improved one description.

Quick Self-Assessment

My strongest sentence was:	
One thing I improved during editing was:	

Parent Tip

Act out the feeling together, then write down the actions. This makes description easier and more natural.

Teacher Tip

Ask students to compare a tell sentence and a show sentence, then discuss which creates a stronger image.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____
Next step: _____